



In This CORNER
by bill hodge

Spencer's Big Year

THE SUN SHINES brightly for Daryl Spencer these days—after six years in the majors he has gotten hot.

The 28-year-old Wichita native rang up his seventh and eighth home runs of the season Tuesday night for the San Francisco Giants and ran his runs batted-in total to 23.

In all of last season the best he could muster was 11 runs.

Spencer right now is hitting a resounding .364 and that too compares most-favorably with the .243 mark he had last year.

The 250-foot leftfield wall in the Los Angeles Coliseum, of course, has been a big help to the Wichitan.

Five of his home runs have sailed out of the Coliseum when the Giants visited the Los Angeles Dodgers.

But the short fence at the Coliseum can't grab credit for his high batting average.

He has been up to swing off-



DARYL SPENCER
... Nears '37 Mark Early ...

etally 103 times in the current campaign—and successfully on 37 of those occasions.

The fact Spencer, for a first time, didn't have to battle for his regular position may have contributed to his fine early start this season.

He hasn't had much pressure. And he has less now.

Andre Rodgers, who aspires to play shortstop for San Francisco, was optioned to Phoenix Tuesday.

It looks like Spencer has made his job in a big way. Right now he seems to be pointing for his best season.

All Like Wichita

EVERYBODY SAYS Milwaukee will win the National League pennant and the Wichita Braves will be hot hot contenders for the American Association flag.

Latest to tag the Wichita club as an Association flag contender was Bill Norman of the visiting Charleston Senators Tuesday night in Lawrence Stadium.

"We need hitting," the Senators manager pointed. "Wichita maybe does too, but you know Milwaukee is going to give it to them. I don't know where our's is coming from."

Others who have tagged Wichita as a contender have been Gene Mauch of the Minneapolis Millers and Andy Cohen of the Denver Bears.

John Keane of the Omaha Cardinals didn't do so, but then we don't know that he ever was asked.

Braves Manager Ben Geraghty concurs with the opinions of managers Norman, Cohen and Mauch.

"I think we're ready to go places," he says.

One Real Bad Call

ABOUT ONCE EVERY 10 years we disagree in print with the ruling of a baseball umpire or a basketball official.

Our reasoning is that the official—although he may boot one once in awhile—is only human. And also that he is closer to the action than anybody else and therefore what may look to be one thing at a distance may be something entirely different.

But Tuesday night at Lawrence Stadium, plate umpire Bill Kinnamon made the blue ribbon error.

He called "Ball Two" on Charleston outfielder Stan Palya when Palya was swinging for the fence!

Everybody has days like that, of course.